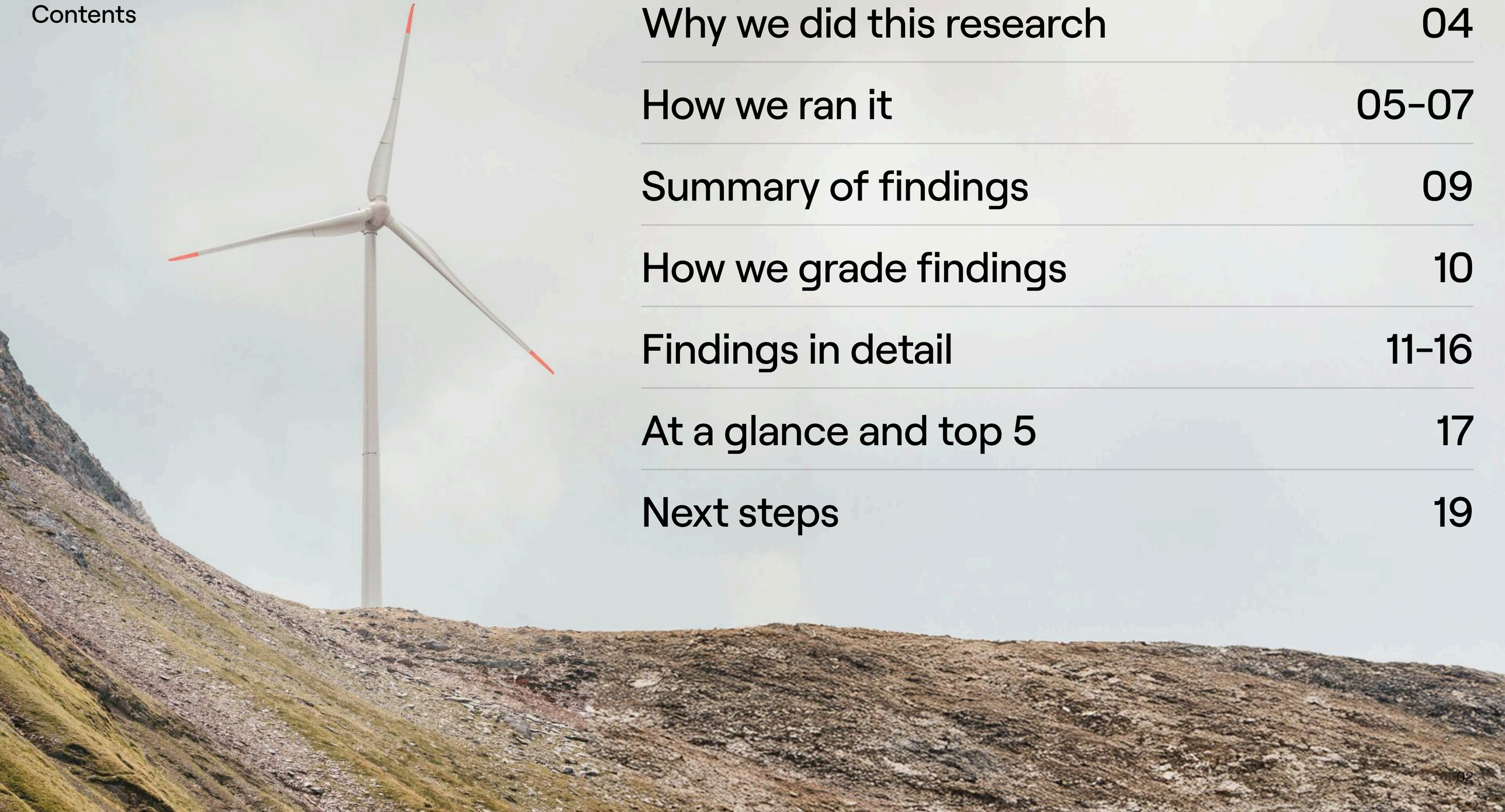
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Adding a Scheduled Report in Astral

Usability testing report
September 2026

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01 Why and How

Why We Did This Research

The problem

- Setting up a scheduled report is one of the most common Reports queries.
- Account managers hear that it “takes a few goes” to get right.
- Add a report is about to open to every customer user.

What we wanted to learn

- Can people add a scheduled report without help?
- Do they know when it sends and which dates it covers?
- Do they know who can see and change it?

What it will inform

- Fixes before Add a report goes to all customers.
- Default settings for recipients and schedules.
- Our next research activity on schedules.

How We Ran It

Moderated remote usability test

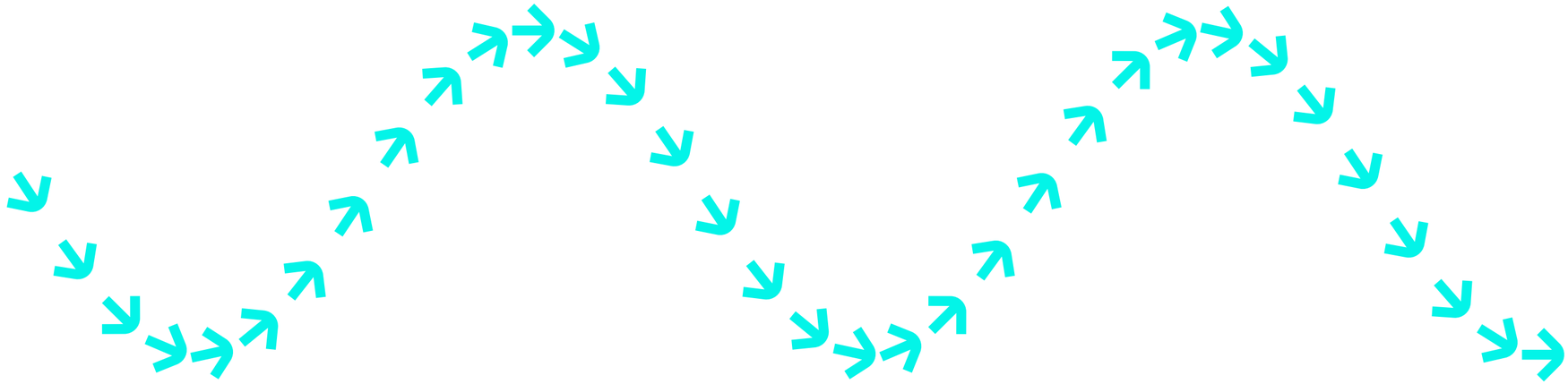
The set-up:

Format	One to one on Teams, thinking aloud
Sessions	45 minutes each
Dates	1 to 4 September 2026
Prototype	Astral, Reports area
Measures	Completion, time on task, ease 1 to 5

People took part, across
customer, broker and admin roles:

6

Who We Spoke To



P01	**Energy manager** Customer, retail, 40 sites	
P02	**Finance analyst** Customer, logistics, 12 sites	
P03	**Account lead** Broker, 30 clients	
P04	**Facilities manager** Customer, public sector, new to Astral	
P05	**Customer success** IMSERV admin	
P06	**Sustainability lead** Customer, manufacturing, 8 sites	

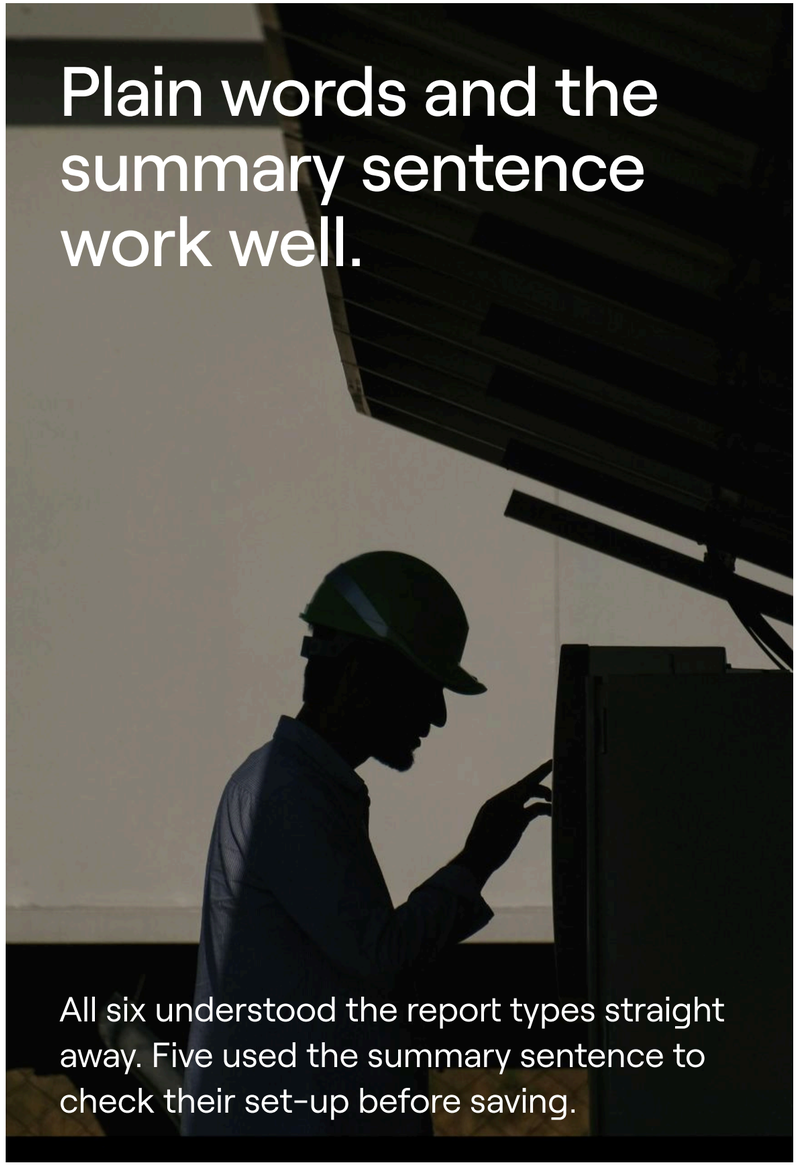
Tasks and How People Got On

Task	Completed	Median time	Ease, 1 to 5
T1 Find a report and check when it next sends	6 of 6	0:42	4.5
T2 Add a weekly interval data report for two sites	4 of 6 2 needed help	4:50	2.8
T3 Change the report to monthly	6 of 6	1:05	4.2
T4 Add a recipient and send yourself a test	6 of 6	1:40	3.9
T5 Find a file you downloaded last week	5 of 6	1:20	3.6

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02 What We Found

Summary of Findings



Plain words and the summary sentence work well.

All six understood the report types straight away. Five used the summary sentence to check their set-up before saving.

One default could share data with the wrong people.

New recipients get Can edit. Four of six did not notice, so outside contacts could change what gets sent.

Hidden reasons slow everyone down.

Add report was blocked with the reason in the footer, and settings sat behind six tabs. Median time for T2 was 4 min 50 s against a 2 minute target.

How We Grade Each Finding

From least to most serious. Each grade has its own shape and colour, so it still reads in black and white.

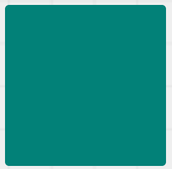


Positive

Something that works well. People got through it with ease or told us they liked it.

WHAT WE DO

Keep and protect it



Low

A small inconvenience. It may add a little time to the task.

WHAT WE DO

Fix when we are working nearby



Medium

The person stops and is challenged, but can get round the issue with some friction.

WHAT WE DO

Plan into an upcoming sprint

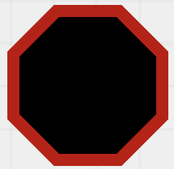


High

The person cannot continue with their task, or needs help in order to continue.

WHAT WE DO

Fix before release



Critical

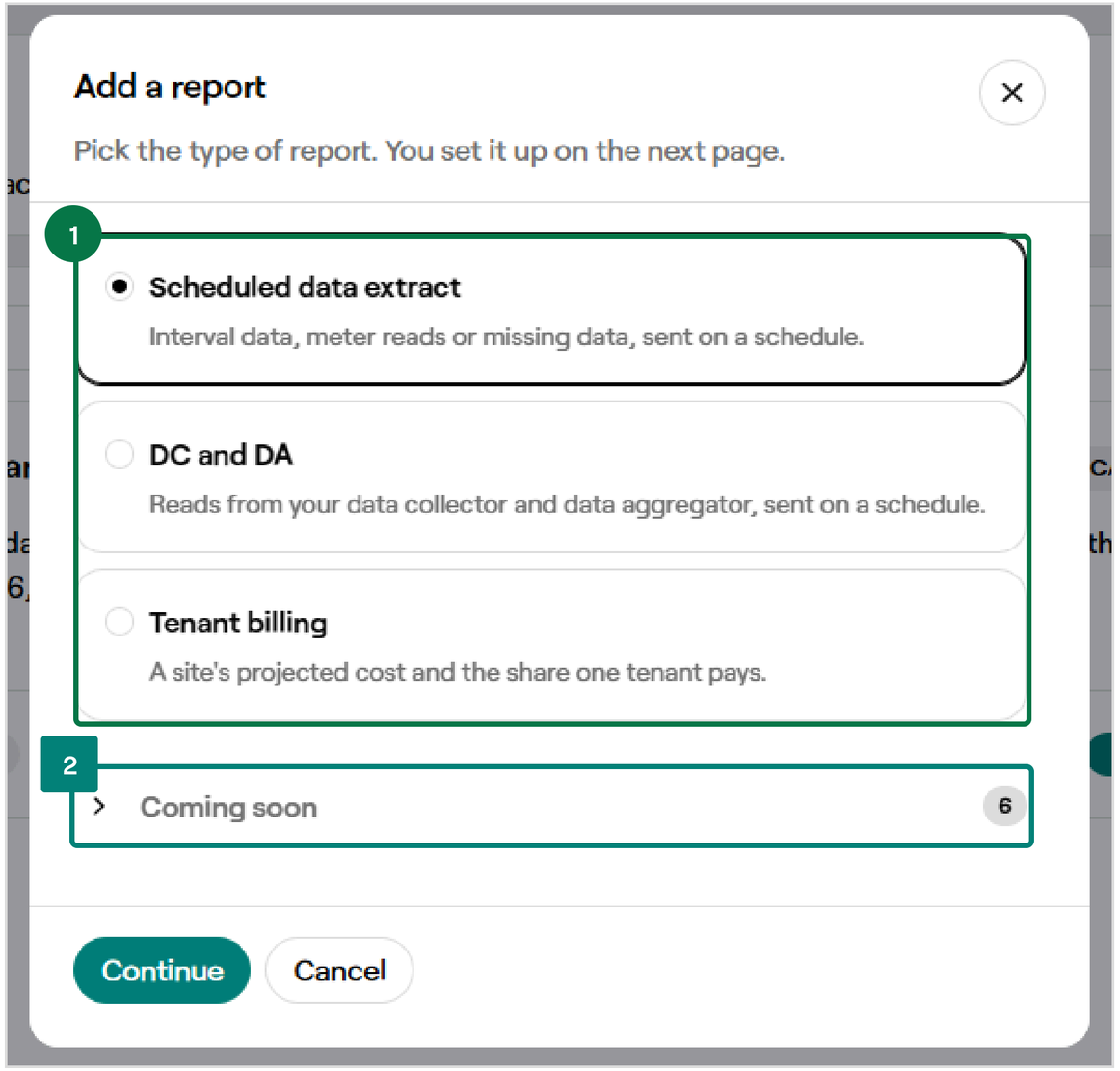
More than the person's task is affected. It could hurt the company's finances, or put the person or their client at risk of something going very wrong.

WHAT WE DO

Stop and fix now

Choosing a Report Type

FINDINGS 01 TO 02



Add a report, step 1: pick a report type

1

POSITIVE F01

Report types make sense in plain words

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Add a report, the report type picker.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

All six picked the right type first time, in under 20 seconds.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

It shows short, plain descriptions work. Other pickers in Astral can follow it.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Keep the one-line descriptions and use the same pattern for new types.

2

LOW F02

Coming soon competes with real choices

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Bottom of the report type picker.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Two people opened Coming soon looking for a missing data report, then came back.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

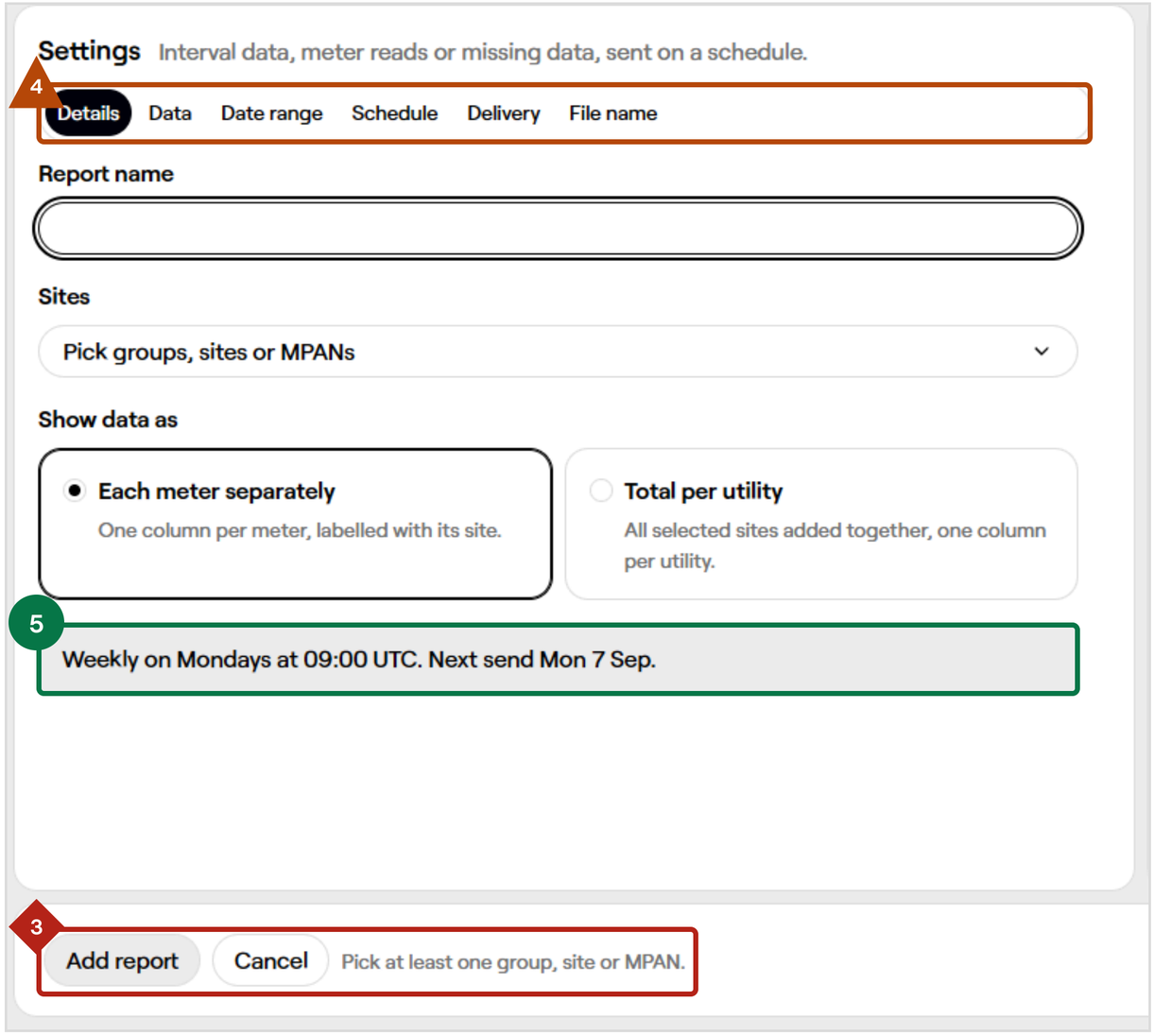
It adds a detour to the first step and offers things people cannot use yet.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Move coming soon types out of the picker, or grey them out under a clear heading.

Settings and Saving

FINDINGS 03 TO 05



Add a report: Details tab and footer

3

HIGH F03

Add report is blocked and the reason is hidden

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Footer of Add a report. The hint sits next to Cancel.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Four of six pressed Add report again and again. Two asked us what was wrong.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

People cannot finish the main task without help, so they give up or raise a query.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Show what is missing next to its field, and take people there when they press Add report.

4

MEDIUM F04

Required settings sit behind six tabs

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Settings tabs, from Details to File name.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Five people opened every tab to check they had not missed anything.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

It adds time and doubt to every new report, and Sites is easy to skip.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Mark the tabs that need input, and show a tick when each one is done.

5

POSITIVE F05

The summary sentence builds confidence

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Grey summary under the settings.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Five people read it aloud to check their set-up before saving.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

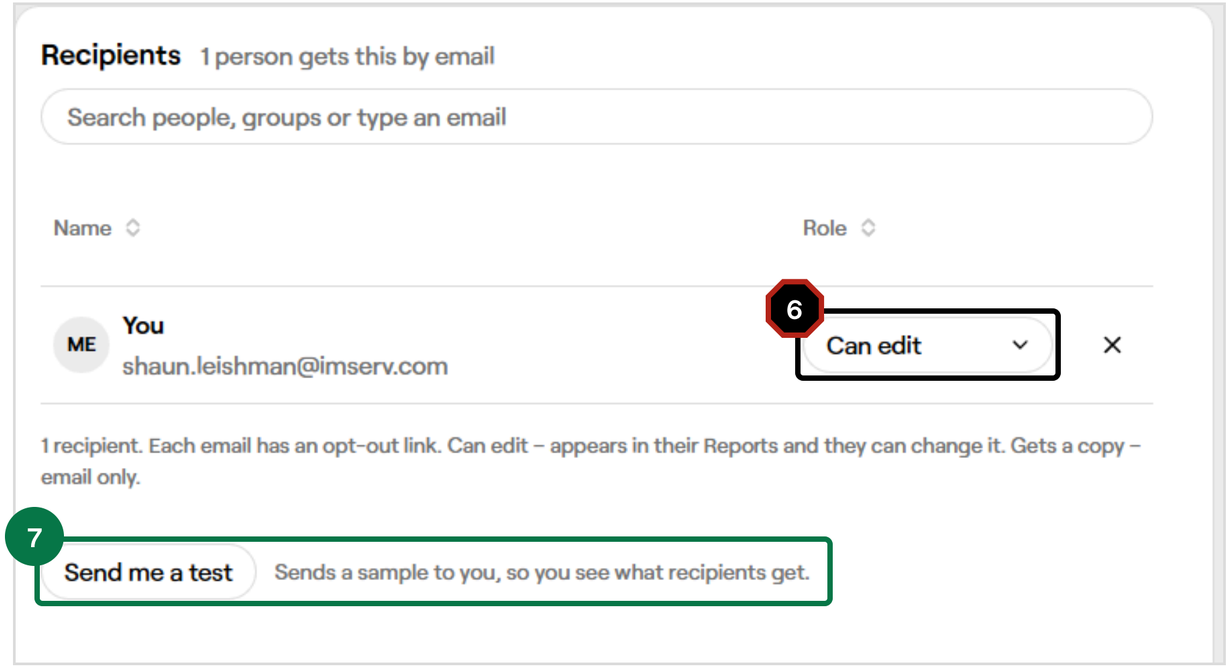
It is the one place that says what will happen, in their words.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Keep it, and add the sites and date range so it covers the whole report.

Who Gets the Report

FINDINGS 06 TO 07



Add a report: Recipients

6 CRITICAL F06

New recipients can edit by default

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Recipients, Role column. Everyone added gets Can edit.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Four of six added an outside contact and left Can edit on. None of them noticed.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

Outside contacts could change sites and recipients and see other clients' data. That is a data protection and contract risk for us and the client.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Default new people to Gets a copy. Ask people to confirm before giving edit rights to anyone outside their company.

7 POSITIVE F07

Send me a test is trusted

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Under the recipient list.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Five people used it before saving. Three said it would stop them sending the wrong file.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

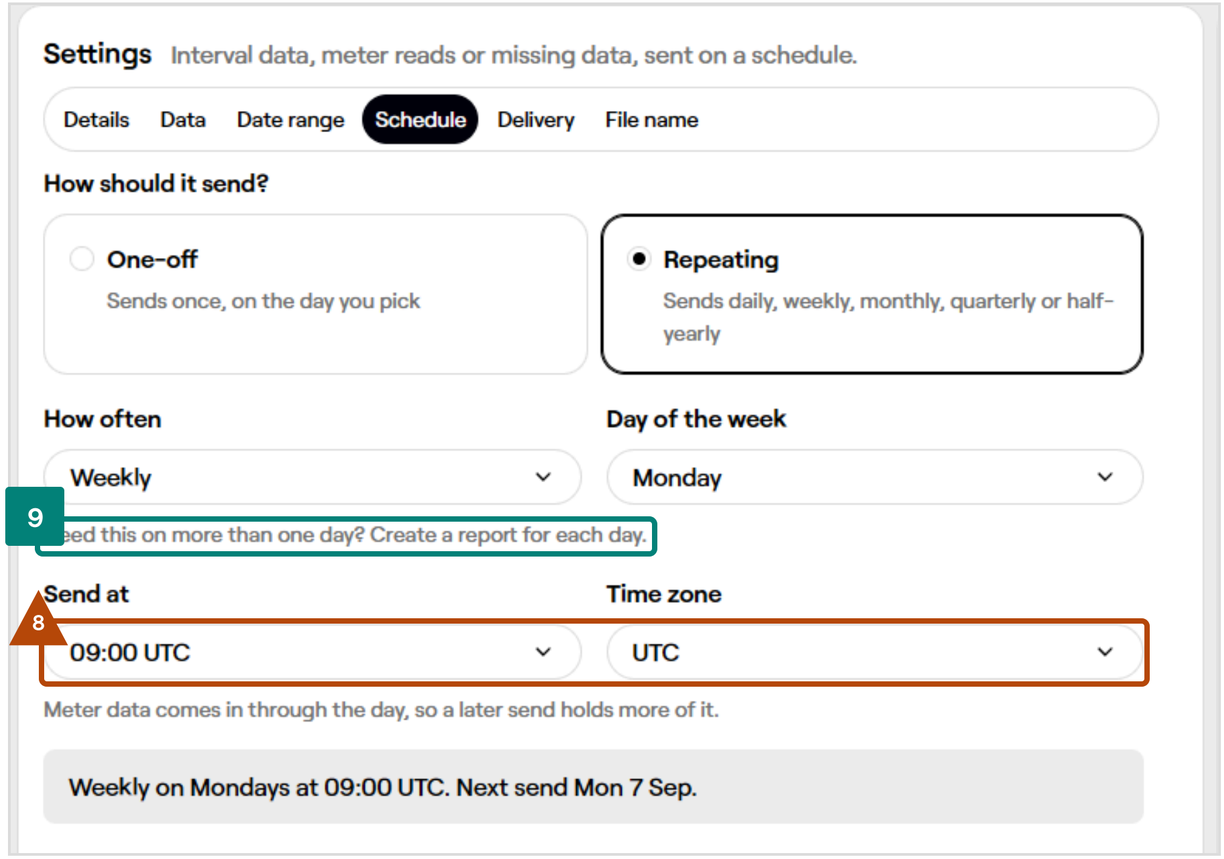
People can check their work safely, which cuts support queries.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Keep it, and show when the test was sent and to which inbox.

When It Sends

FINDINGS 08 TO 09



Add a report: Schedule tab

8

MEDIUM F08

Send time is in UTC, not UK time

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Schedule, Send at and Time zone.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Three people set 09:00 and expected 9am UK time. In summer it lands at 10am.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

Reports arrive an hour late for half the year, after the meetings they are for.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Default to UK time and show the local send time in the summary.

9

LOW F09

Only one send day per report

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Schedule, the hint under How often.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Two people wanted Monday and Thursday sends and had to make two reports.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

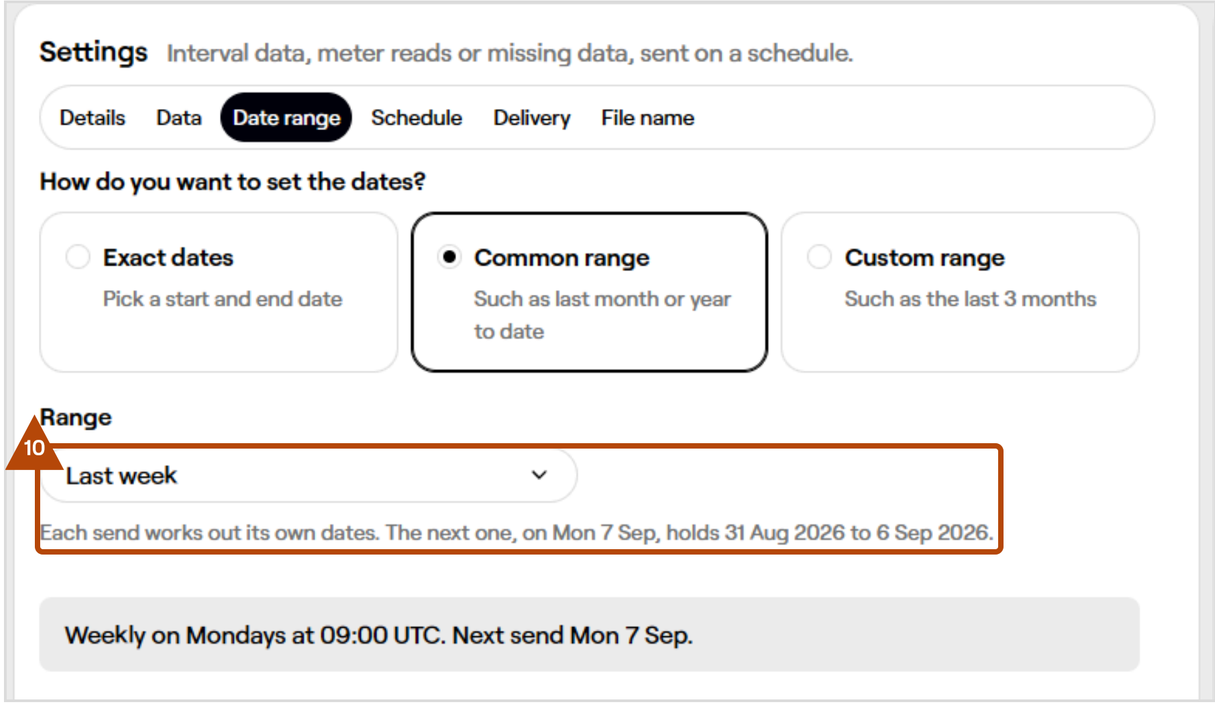
Copies drift apart over time and double the work to keep them right.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Let people pick more than one day for weekly reports.

Which Dates It Covers

FINDING 10



Add a report: Date range tab

10

MEDIUM F10

Last week does not say which week

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Date range, the Range drop-down.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Four people were unsure if Last week meant Monday to Sunday or the last 7 days. The exact dates sit in the hint, but only one person read it.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

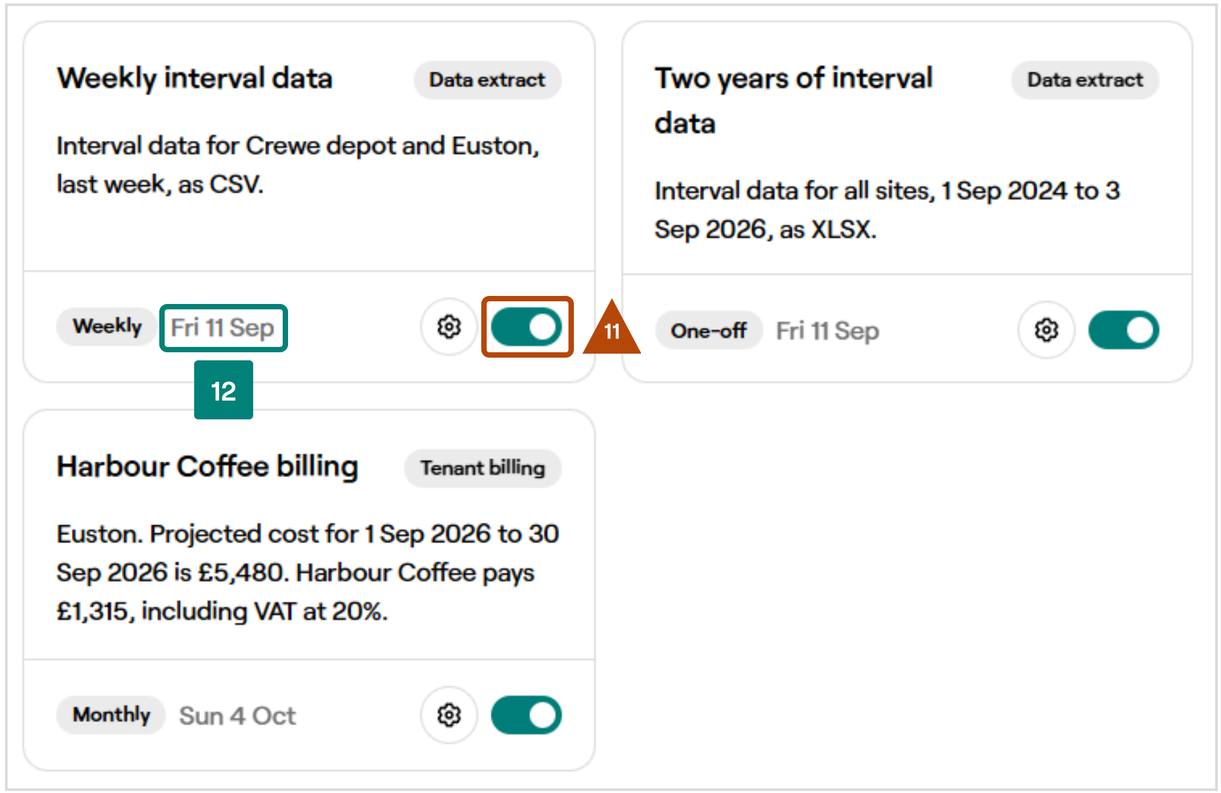
People may share the wrong days and make decisions on part of the data.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

> Show the dates in the choice itself, for example Last week, 31 Aug to 6 Sep.

Managing Reports

FINDINGS 11 TO 12



Reports and compliance: report cards

11

MEDIUM F11

The toggle does not say what it does

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Report cards, the switch next to settings.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Three people thought it deleted the report. Two thought it sent it now.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

People avoid it, or pause reports others rely on by mistake.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Label it Sending or Paused, and confirm before pausing a shared report.

12

LOW F12

Next send date has no label

WHERE WE FOUND IT

Report cards, the date next to the frequency.

HOW IT AFFECTED PEOPLE

Two people read Fri 11 Sep as the date the report was made.

WHY IT IS IMPORTANT TO FIX

A small slow-down when checking when data will arrive.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Add a short label: Next send Fri 11 Sep.

At a Glance

12 findings from 6 sessions



Top 5 to Fix First

Ordered by severity, then by how many people it affected.

1

6 CRITICAL · F06

New recipients can edit by default

Default new recipients to Gets a copy

2

3 HIGH · F03

Add report is blocked and the reason is hidden

Show what is blocking Add report next to the field

3

10 MEDIUM · F10

Last week does not say which week

Put the exact dates in each date range choice

4

8 MEDIUM · F08

Send time is in UTC, not UK time

Default the send time to UK time

5

11 MEDIUM · F11

The toggle does not say what it does

Label the toggle Sending or Paused



03 What Happens Next

Next Steps

1. Fix the edit default

Surfaced: defaults carry real risk

This sprint. New recipients get Gets a copy, with a check for outside emails. Re-test with three people before release.

2. Make blockers visible

Surfaced: people cannot see what is missing

Next sprint. Show what is missing next to each field, tick finished tabs and default to UK time. Aim for T2 in under 2 minutes.

3. Learn how people schedule

Surfaced: real schedules are more varied than we built for

Next research activity. A short survey of 30 report owners on the days, times and date ranges they need, then a quick follow-up test.

Thank You

Thanks to the six customers, brokers and colleagues who gave us their time. Here is who worked on this study.

SL

Shaun Leishman
Lead researcher and facilitator

–

[Name]
Note-taker

–

[Name]
Product designer

–

[Name]
Product owner

